

OnePlus Nord Buds 4 Pro

Well-balanced TWS earbuds under ₹5000?

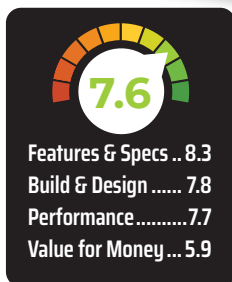
People often ask me for the best truly wireless earbuds recommendation under Rs 5,000. To be frank, the sub-Rs 5,000 TWS space is one of the most competitive segments right now, where brands are actively trying to bring premium features down to mass-market pricing. OnePlus, for instance, has several options in this price range, and now, the company has launched yet another addition to the list, for Rs 3,999, or Rs 3,799 if you count in the introductory offer, the OnePlus Nord Buds 4 Pro. On paper, the new Buds 4 Pro tries to tick almost every box, including 55dB ANC, LHDC support, spatial audio, and Bluetooth 6.0. That, my friend, is an enticing bouquet of specs and features, but also something that can be found in its rivals like the Realme Buds Air 8.

In this review of the OnePlus Nord Buds 4 Pro, you can find my experience with the earbuds in everyday use, it may help you decide whether it's worth buying.

DESIGN AND COMFORT

The OnePlus Nord Buds 4 Pro has a rounded rectangular case, almost pebble-like, with OnePlus branding and an LED indicator on the front. There's nothing on the back. But on the base, you get a USB-C port and a pairing/reset button. Our grey coloured review unit looks sober. I am sure the black one also shares the understated look.

The case is small, comfortable to hold and doesn't bulge much from my jeans pocket. With the buds inside, they weigh around 43 grams.



The earbuds themselves are only 4.4 grams, and along with the small stem and silicone ear tips, they stay put in my ears. I am usually wary of wearing earbuds on the move, but I didn't have that worry with these. They can be comfortably worn for hours at a stretch. For a week or so, they are constantly in my ear while working, commuting on the metro and at home. They weren't loosening during light workouts, too.

Speaking of workouts, the IP55 rating means the Nord Buds 4 Pro can take some sweat, light splashes while washing your face and even some dust and rain outside.

The stem's narrow dimple and sliding for volume is a good touch.

Overall, there is nothing fancy about the design. It looks sober and is functional, which is what matters.

CONNECTIVITY

The OnePlus Nord Buds 4 Pro carry audio via Bluetooth 6.0, and the connection has been stable. You can easily pair them with Google Fast Pair, and I had no difficulty pairing them with an iPhone and a MacBook Air. Thanks to dual-device connectivity, you can listen to two devices at the same time, and this worked reliably between my Android phone and MacBook.

The company claims low latency up to 47ms, and enabling Game Mode in the HeyMelody app, I faced no latency issues while casual gaming and video streaming.

On non OnePlus and Oppo phones, the HeyMelody app is where you can find and change ANC, Transparency mode, dual connection, OnePlus 3D Audio, EQ profiles, Spotify Tap, touch controls, AI Translate, upgrade firmware, and track earbuds if lost or misplaced. The interface is straightforward. So, I had no problem navigating.

As for navigating the earbuds' functions, the app offers ample choices. You get to tweak controls for single tap, double tap, triple tap, slide on, and touch-&-hold on both sides. As already mentioned, the sliding on the dimple to lower/raise volume works fine.

All good here.

SOUND QUALITY

At the core of the OnePlus Nord Buds 4 Pro is a 12mm dynamic driver, which is relatively large for this category. Its rival, the Realme Buds Air 8, comes with a dual driver setup, consisting of dedicated drivers for bass and treble.

It has an elevated bass tuning with punchy, warm low end, ample rumble, and, in fact, there's bass presence almost every time. But you can still make out vocals and instruments. Don't expect too much detail in the high notes. But, overall, it is a safe, fun, and engaging sound.